



Knit **it** NOW

Helping you be a better knitter!

Pockets for Machine Knitters

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Why Add Pockets?

Pockets are not a necessary item to a garment. They are just additions that have useful functions, enhance the looks, or even just cover a flaw or a place that has been darned.

Pockets have been around as long as we have worn clothes. They have evolved through our lifestyles. And, they will always be included in our fashions because of their usefulness and decorative appearance.



*"All of these things
play a part in your
decisions of putting
in some pockets."*

Pockets can be pretty and embellished in so many ways, to add spice to anything. Pockets can be hidden and just do their job. Pockets can keep us warm or just carry our most precious possession - even if it is a live pet frog or a bright shiny piece of money, or chewing gum.

Any way you look at it - pockets are here to stay. So, we might as well learn as much about them as possible and have some fun.

Size and Placement of Pockets

It is YOUR decision where to place your pockets and which kind you want.

Here are some guide lines as to placement and the size of ordinary pockets.

Don't hesitate to make your pocket size fit your designs.

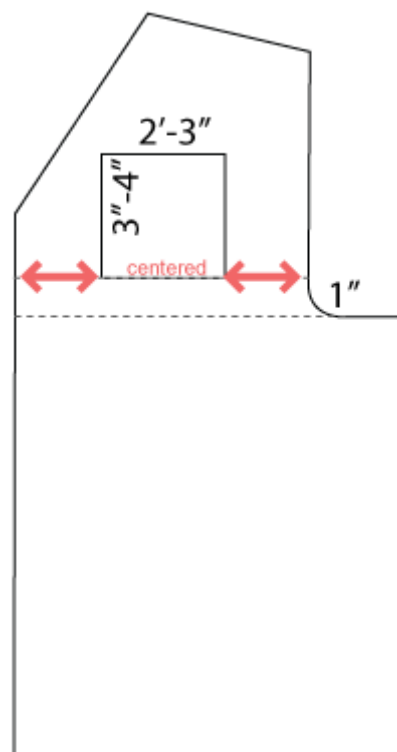
Breast (Bust) Pockets



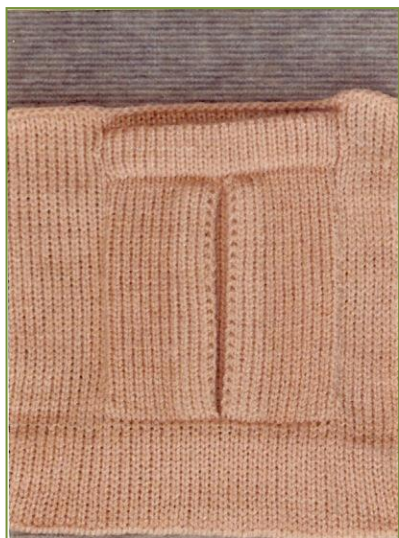
Breast, (or bust) pockets usually have their openings about 1" above the beginning of the armhole shaping. They are generally placed in the center of the side of a cardigan, jacket, or shirt. If only one pocket is knit, place it on the left side of chest. Also, this side is the place for a monogram.

Breast pockets are usually square and are smaller than those used at the waist. Small pockets (Polo Shirt Type) are usually 2" to 3" in width and 3" to 4" in length.

On a V-Neck garment, the breast pocket usually is centered between the armhole and the edge of the V at the point about 1 inch above the start of armhole decreases.



Waist pockets are usually placed just after the hem has been enclosed or the ribbing completed. They are placed slightly off center toward the side seam.



Waist pockets are slightly wider than breast pockets.

Also, they are longer than wide. Usually pockets on jackets or sweaters range from 4" to 5" in width, and 5" to 6" in length on adult garments. Children's pockets are scaled down but remain still longer than wider.

[Click here](#) for the Knit it Now 3 part tutorial for knitting this pocket

Patch pockets can be any size and placed anywhere you wish at any angle. It is best to hand sew these pockets on after garment is completed. These are great for covering defects and hiding holes that have been darned.

Decorative (False) pockets can be any shape and size that pleases you.

Zippered pockets can also be placed wherever you choose and the opening can be any length.

Some Requirements of Pockets

Decorative Pockets

In pockets that are decorative, or pretending to work, there is little to concern



ourselves with this type sagging or getting out of shape. Most of the time, these pockets are knitted at the main garment tension. Some are knitted before and slipped into the garment while we are knitting. Others are knitted in as the garment is progressing.

Functional Pockets

A functional pocket does require certain qualities that will make it perform as desired. For instance, the knitting needs to be firm enough to hold its shape with hands, toys, tools, etc. popping in and out. Nothing could be less desirable than to have pockets in a garment and not be able to use them. They must be big enough for hands to slip into, items to be retrieved, and still look great on the garment with nothing in them.

Zippered pockets

Zippered pockets are great. They will need a very firm edge to sew in the zipper. Slash (or slanted) pockets will need a definite back facing to make sure they stay as designed. These pockets can be positioned in many places. ([See "Weaving a Stable Edge" below](#))



Stabilizing the Pocket Shape

Knitting pockets too loosely will produce unwanted results. For that reason it is best to never use a soft fine yarn for pockets unless it is used as an interlining for placing fusing or interfacing material. If you plait or twist a soft yarn with sewing thread or some other hard twisted thin yarn, this will stabilize the pocket, and help retain it's original shape. Best try a swatch of this beforehand.

"It is best to never use a soft fine yarn for pockets"

A pretty lace pocket looks beautiful on a garment when it is lined, but is very impractical if you do not take the extra time to back it with matching material, fuse it with an interlining, or knit a backing with thinner yarn.

Most hard finished yarns make great pockets. They retain their shape without much help when knitted tightly enough. If you knit a hidden pocket into a skirt or pair of slacks, there are ways to keep it from sticking out of the pocket when you stand up. The edges of these pockets must stay secure and neat.

Stabilize the Pocket Top

The key to good looking and functional pockets is how much strain they can take without sagging or bagging. Of course, in a knitted fabric we can't expect to carry a lot of weight. But, we do know that hands will be shoved into them a great many times.

" The key to good looking and functional pockets is how much strain they can take without sagging or bagging."

There are several ways to help them maintain their shape so they will be enjoyed.

1. **Use interfacing and fusing material.** Personally, if I can get a piece of interfacing into the top of the pocket by making the top, or flap, of the pocket double, this is best.

Fusing with something like "Stitch Witchery" will make the material stiff and prevent the knit from stretching. But, if done in between linings, it does a terrific job. In making the lining of a pocket, just knit another piece of very soft thin yarn the same size. Before knitting the pocket lining into place, fuse this second piece to the first lining. This can then be knit in as only one piece.

2. For the Slash Pockets, Slanted Pockets, or Plain Pockets on a heavy fabric, knit the "[Bound Buttonhole Facing](#)" around the opening. It really holds the pocket opening tightly.

3. The **top of the pocket should be very stable**. It will be the first part of the pocket to give under stress. This can be helped by:

- Knitting the top in a tighter tension
- Knitting a ribbing
- Placing some interfacing in the doubled cuff of this pocket.
- Often, one can help the top of a sagging pocket by running an extra strand of yarn through the casement of the pocket, and then securing it to each side of garment. Don't make it too tight or hands will break this support. A strand or two of elastic woven into the casement helps too.

Bound Buttonhole Style Facing For Pockets and Openings

*Try this facing method to stabilize a pocket.
Follow the step-by-step instructions with some scrap yarn and
incorporate this professional finishing technique in your next project*

After your garment is completed, blocked, and sewn together, knit this facing around pocket opening to stabilize the pocket.



Facing Step-by-Step Instructions

R.C. 0. Cast-on with "e" wraps - 4 stitches.

Increase with a two prong tool on each side of these stitches: 1-2-8.
(one stitch, every two rows, eight times on each side).

You now have 20 stitches.

Be sure to pull needles out into Hold (E) position to keep them from falling off for the first four rows.

R.C. 18 Scrap off 10 sts. on the left side of this piece with six rows of scrap yarn. Remove them from machine.

We will knit the remaining half of the facing and hang one side of the pocket opening by "[sew-as-you-knit](#)".

With purl sides facing each other, hang the first stitch of the pocket's opening edge on the first needle of left hand side of the facing. Knit 2 rows.

Hang next loop of the pocket opening edge onto the same first needle on the left hand side of the facing. Knit 2 rows.

Continue in this manner until all loops have been hung from edge of the pocket while knitting the facing.

Make note of the row counter reading.

Scrap off this part of the facing with 6 rows of scrap yarn.

Continued....

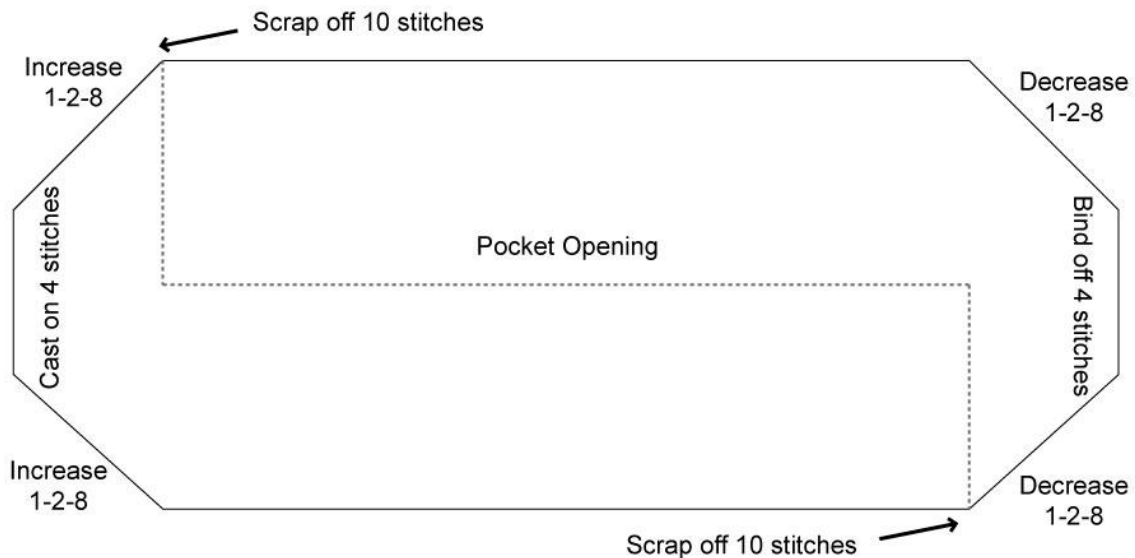
R.C. 18. AGAIN. Rehang the stitches from the first part of the facing you previously scrapped off.

Hang the first loop of the other side of pocket opening on the first needle of the right hand side of the facing. Knit 2 rows.

Continue on using the "sew-as-you-knit" method until you reach the other end of the pocket opening. (If this pocket is put in on a slant, it is okay. You will just have more rows knitted on one side than the other).

Remember - purl side to purl side. When both sides of the pocket have been knitted into the facing, pick up and rehang stitches that you scrapped off on the other side of the facing. Decrease both sides of the facing now with a two prong tool 1-2-8. (one stitch, every two rows, eight times on each side).

Latch Tool Bind off the remaining 4 stitches.



Weaving a Stable Edge for Some Pockets

This edge is particularly nice for a pocket on a seam or for a zippered pocket. It gives a nice look, firm edge, and a place to sew in a zipper.

Vertical Opening

For a vertical opening, take an extra-long piece of main garment yarn, and just weave this yarn over and under the stems of the needles of the first three, or four, stitches on the outside seam edge of the pocket piece, as you are knitting the rows. If this is a vertical opening in the middle of a garment, wrap each side with a strand of yarn for each side.



Horizontal Opening

1. ["e" wrap](#) an extra strand of yarn over all the pocket stitches AND at least two extra stitches at beginning and end of pocket opening.
2. Do this for 3 rows before the opening.
3. Latch Tool Bind off the pocket stitches
4. [Double "e" wrap](#) over the empty needles to put the pocket stitches back on.

